

AI BEAVERS founder hackathon - Logistics

House of AI Hamburg · Hongkongstraße 2, 20457 Hamburg · Saturday, June 6, 2026 · 09:00–21:00

Event page: <https://luma.com/hmqh70k1>

Discord: <https://discord.gg/MCYGuUQ2vd>

This is the practical guide for the day: where to go, what to bring, what you can use, what you submit, and how judging works.

Read the [Ideas & Strategy guide](#) before June 6. This doc covers logistics. The other half - how to find a fundable idea, sharpen your wedge, stress-test it, and understand exactly what the VC and angel judges look for - lives in the Ideas & Strategy guide. It will change how you prepare.

Live Q&A: Tuesday, June 2 at 19:00 (7 PM). Join the [Discord](#) general voice channel. Drop in to ask anything about the event, teams, ideas, or judging. Everyone is welcome - no need to sign up.

Read this first

- **Arrive:** be there at 09:00 sharp. Check-in is 09:00–09:45 and the intro starts at 09:45 - be in the room by then. The earlier you're in, the more building time you get; we don't want to waste any.
- **Check-in:** show your approved Luma registration at the entrance. If asked, be ready to show ID matching your registration name.
- **Late arrivals:** come anyway - go straight to check-in or the help desk. Arriving after the intro may make it harder to join a team.
- **Team size:** 2–4 people recommended, max 4 (sweet spot 2–3). Solo is allowed, but we strongly recommend at least one teammate.
- **Before the event:** finding teammates early is a fair advantage. A team mostly formed before June 6 can start building much faster.
- **Submission deadline:** 19:00 sharp. Everyone submits something by then.
- **If you miss the deadline:** 19:00 is a hard cut. Miss it and you're out of judging - no extensions, no exceptions. Submit something by 19:00 even if it's unfinished.
- **Required at submission:** public GitHub repo + pitch deck (max 7 slides).
- **Preferred but optional:** live demo or hosted preview URL.
- **Pitching:** everyone pitches live on-site. No demo video required.

- **Judging:** read the full judging and scoring guide → <https://docs.google.com/document/d/1oYZ8MwMlcYTdA2wAQIUTBexxxzLDJrz9i4SZZdjNZnA>
-

Team formation

You can participate in teams of 2–4 people. The sweet spot is usually 2–3: enough range to cover product, build, and pitch, but small enough to move fast without heavy coordination.

The best move is to find teammates before the event. That is a fair advantage: you save the morning search and alignment time, arrive with roles mostly clear, and start building as soon as the event begins.

Use Discord before June 6 to introduce yourself: say what you can build or contribute, what customer or workflow you understand, and what kind of teammate you are looking for.

Solo builders are allowed, but we strongly recommend finding at least one teammate. A one-person team can work if the scope is extremely narrow, but it is much harder to build, validate, design, and pitch well in one day. If you arrive solo, use Discord [#find-your-team](#) and the morning window to find one or two strong teammates.

What makes a good team

- One person owns build / engineering speed.
- One person owns product / customer clarity.
- One person owns pitch, demo flow, and evidence.
- Everyone can explain the problem and help with the final pitch.

Keep the team small and decisive. Avoid spending the morning debating the perfect idea. Pick a painful problem, define a narrow demo, assign owners, and start building.

Good team-formation questions

- What can each person ship today?
 - Who understands the customer or workflow best?
 - Who can make the demo believable by 19:00?
 - Who will keep the pitch and submission on track?
 - Can we explain the idea in one sentence before we start building?
-

What to bring

- Laptop
- Charger
- Phone
- Any adapters you normally need - especially USB-C / HDMI / power adapters
- Accounts / API keys for tools you already know you may use
- Water bottle for refill
- Idea notes or customer / problem research

We plan to provide light breakfast, lunch, snacks, drinks, and dinner. We'll confirm any changes in Discord. Breakfast is light, so do not arrive starving.

Venue and access

House of AI Hamburg - Hongkongstraße 2, 20457 Hamburg, Germany.

Check in at the entrance. The AI BEAVERS team and volunteers will direct you to the main room, toilets, food area, help desk, and any quiet / work areas.

If you have accessibility needs, dietary constraints, or anything the organizers should know, email hi@ai-beavers.com or tell the check-in / help desk team when you arrive.

WiFi details will be posted on-site and in Discord once confirmed.

Discord channel map

Join before the event: <https://discord.gg/MCYGuUQ2vd>

- **#announcements** - official schedule updates, deadlines, links, and urgent changes.
- **#find-your-team** - find teammates before or during the morning.
- **#help** - practical questions during the day.
- **#resources** - useful links, sponsor / tool credits, templates, and event materials.
- **#submissions** - submission form, deadline reminders, and submission support.
- General / community channels - networking, questions, and non-urgent chat.

If channel names change, follow the pinned message in `#announcements`. Official instructions from organizers override chat rumors.

Rules

Build starts at the hackathon. You may prepare your thinking before the day, but the submitted project must be built during the event.

Allowed: open-source packages, public templates, APIs, no-code tools, AI coding tools, your own generic boilerplate, and idea notes, user research, sketches, and problem analysis prepared before the day.

Not allowed: submitting an existing product, importing a private existing codebase as the project, prebuilt demo flows, fake commit history, plagiarized projects, and presenting another team's work as your own.

Your repo should show meaningful commit history from June 6. Judges or organizers may ask to inspect it.

Already have a startup? Read this carefully

You can still join - but you build fresh on June 6 like everyone else.

Build a focused fresh version, prototype, or demo from scratch on June 6. Do not submit your existing product or private production codebase. This is non-negotiable and applies to every team. Use your market knowledge as an edge, but the project you submit must be built during the event.

Room norms

- Be kind, be on time, and be useful to other builders.
 - Respect other teams' ideas, laptops, whiteboards, and workspaces.
 - Do not record other people's pitches, screens, or conversations without consent.
 - If you need practical help, use Discord `#help` or ask the organizer / help desk team.
-

What you submit at 19:00

Submission happens through a form shared in Discord before the event starts, normally in `#submissions` and `#announcements`.

Required

- **Public GitHub repo** - with README and commit history from the day, so organizers and judges can verify what was built during the hackathon.
- **Pitch deck, max 7 slides** - the deck you will use for your live pitch.

Preferred but optional

- **Live demo or hosted preview URL** - strongly preferred if you have a working version judges can open, but not mandatory.

No demo video required. Everyone pitches live on-site.

Do not fake repo history, import a private existing codebase, or present old work as new. Organizers may inspect repos and ask questions if something looks off.

If your app is not deployed by the deadline, submit the repo and pitch deck anyway. Judges can still evaluate your build, code history, and pitch.

If you do not submit by 19:00

The 19:00 deadline is a hard cut. No extensions, no exceptions. If you have not submitted by then, you are out of the judging round.

Unfinished is fine - submit what you have. A broken demo, a rough deck, a half-built repo all still count. What does not count is missing the deadline. So submit something by 19:00, whatever state it's in.

If a team is not present, not ready, or cannot present when called, organizers move on. Stay near your assigned room / stage after submissions close.

Pitch deck: max 7 slides

Every slide must do work.

1. **Problem + customer** - specific pain, who has it (role, company size, industry), and what they do today to solve it, even badly.
2. **Solution + product** - what you built, how it works, demo link or QR code if available.

3. **Why now** - what changed that makes this possible or urgent now: a new API, a regulation, a cost collapse. For AI startups: what makes this more than a wrapper?
4. **Market + competition** - bottom-up sizing (customer count × revenue per customer, not "1% of a \$100B market"). Direct competitors, indirect alternatives, status quo, and why you win. Never say "we have no competitors."
5. **Business model + traction / evidence** - who pays, how much, how often, and what you validated.
6. **Go-to-market** - how the first 50 customers find you. Name a channel you can actually run, not "we'll do SEO" or "we'll go viral."
7. **Team** - why this team has the right edge. End with contact info.

For inspiration: [50 real startup pitch decks](#) - see how the best decks are built.

Agenda

Times may move slightly, but the hard deadline is 19:00.

Time	What happens
09:00	Doors open, check-in, light breakfast
09:45	Intro from organizers - rules, judging, logistics. Be in the room by 09:45
10:00	Team formation window, then start building. Pre-formed teams lock scope and start fast; solo participants find teammates
13:00	Lunch, keep building
17:00	Two-hour warning
18:00	Dinner + final building sprint
18:30	30-minute warning
19:00	Submission deadline, hard cut. Everyone submits something
19:15	Preliminary pitch rooms open, judges begin review. All teams pitch in assigned rooms: 3 minutes per team, no Q&A
20:15	Judges align and finalists are confirmed
20:30	Finalists announced - expected 7 teams

Time	What happens
20:35	Finalist pitches: 3 minutes pitch + 2 minutes Q&A per team
21:10	Winners announced and official close

How the day works

After the intro and team formation, the day is mostly self-directed. There are no forced checkpoints and no permission gate before you start building.

- Use the deadline warnings to pace yourself.
 - Ask organizers or volunteers for logistics help, not product approval.
 - Judges review submissions and pitches in the evening. Do not expect daytime investor mentoring or pitch practice from judges during the build phase.
 - If you are stuck, use your team, the room, Discord #help, and the organizer / help desk team.
-

How judges decide

The full judging and scoring guide is here:

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1oYZ8MwMlcYTdA2wAQIUTBexxzLDJr9i4SZZdjNZnA>

The spirit is simple: could this become a real company, and did the team execute under pressure?

Judges will look for:

- A painful, specific buyer problem.
- A working demo or credible hosted preview, if submitted.
- A sharp wedge, not a broad platform claim.
- Clear use of AI or modern tooling where it actually improves the product.
- Evidence that someone wants this: user signal, customer conversation, waitlist, pilot interest, usage, or credible domain insight.
- A team that learns quickly and can explain why they are the right people to build it.

You do not need to build the next OpenAI in 12 hours. You need to ship a working product, a clear pitch, and a reason this could only have been built by you.

To understand exactly how judges think - and how to sharpen your idea, wedge, and pitch to meet that bar - read the [Ideas & Strategy guide](#) before June 6. It is the single most useful thing you can do to prepare.

Before June 6 - your checklist

Team

- ☐ Find your team before the event (2–4 people). If solo, post in Discord [#find-your-team](#) and use the morning window.
- ☐ Agree on rough roles: build, product / customer, pitch.

Idea

- ☐ Read the [Ideas & Strategy guide](#) and stress-test your idea against it.
- ☐ Be able to explain the idea in one sentence before you start building.

Logistics

- ☐ Join the Discord: <https://discord.gg/MCYGuUQ2vd>.
 - ☐ Confirm your Luma registration; bring ID matching the name.
 - ☐ Pack laptop, charger, phone, adapters (USB-C / HDMI / power), accounts / API keys, water bottle, idea notes.
 - ☐ Eat - breakfast on-site is light, so don't arrive starving.
 - ☐ Flag any accessibility or dietary needs to hi@ai-beavers.com.
-

Sponsors - use their tools during the event

These partners make the day possible. You're free to build with any of their tools - and some run their own prize tracks (details announced on-site and in Discord #announcements).

- [mollie](#) - payments. Add checkout and payment flows to your product.
- [OpenAI](#) - frontier models via API. Call GPT models inside your app.
- [Cursor](#) - AI code editor. Build your whole project in it.
- [Qwen](#) - open models via API for LLM requests, plus Qwen Code, their agent coding tool with sub-agents.
- [Bilt](#) - build mobile apps with AI. Ship an app without a native team.
- [ElevenLabs](#) - voice AI. Add realistic speech and voice agents to your product.
- [SAGEOBOT](#) - helps founders get found on Google and cited by AI - search and AI visibility.
- [House of AI](#) - our venue. Also offers free co-working space for selected AI founders.

If you were selected, it is because we believe you can do this.

See you June 6.

The AI BEAVERS crew
hi@ai-beavers.com